Session 1 Presentation

for Tales of Defiance to Mind Control in the Modern Age

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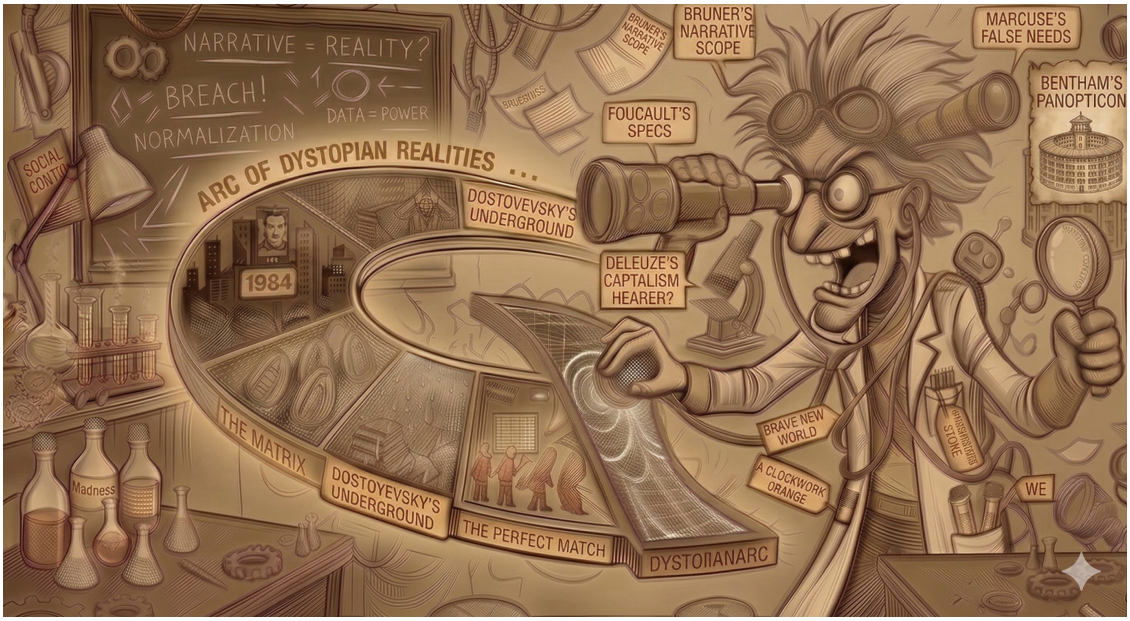
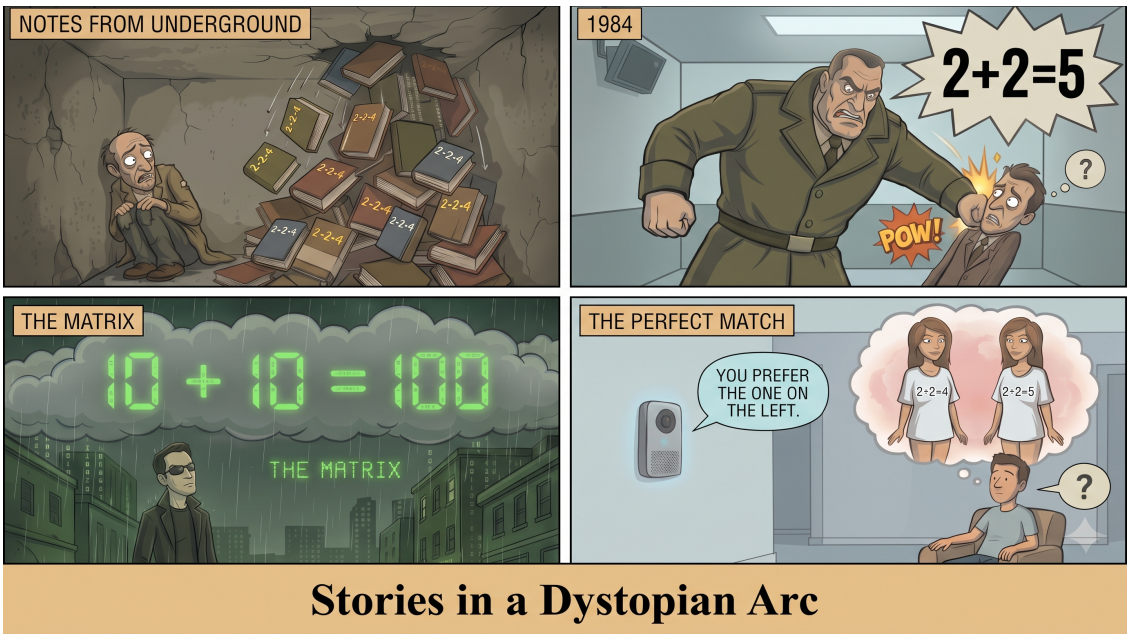
Course Overview:



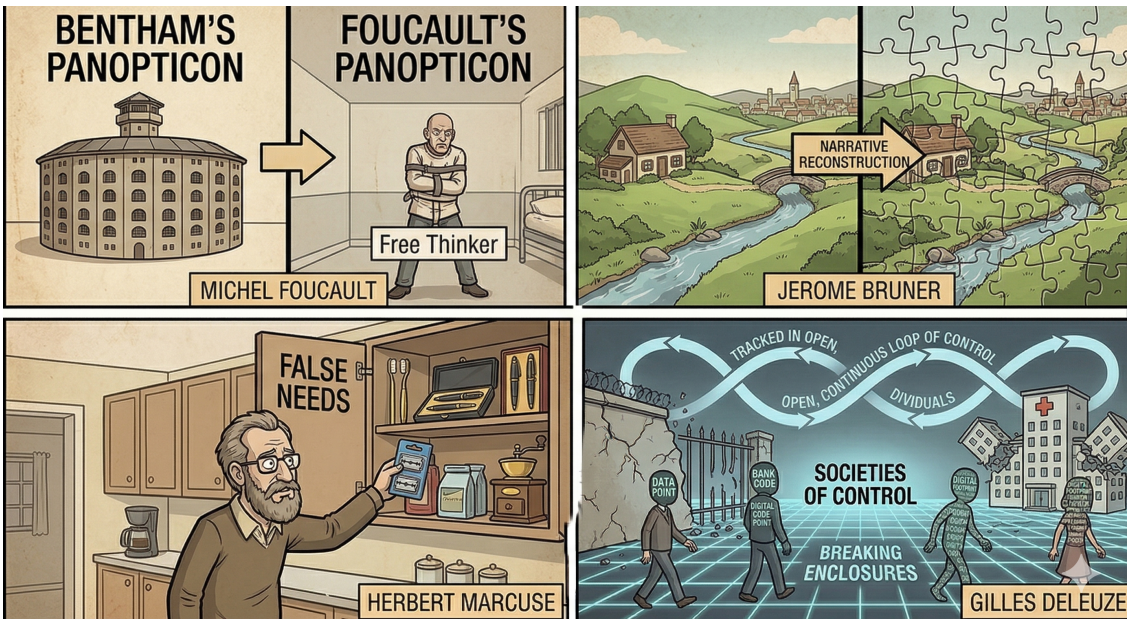
- Look at modern age stories where societies impose/offer mind control.
- Consider characters who are rebelling.
- Ask questions through various lenses.

Stories in a Dystopian Arc



- Dostoyevsky's Underground Man, isolated and being crushed by 2+2=4 reason .
- Winston from "1984" being pounded by Big Brother to truly believe 2+2=5.
- Neo from "The Matrix" perceiving that his entire world is a computer simulation, seeing the simulation of 2+2=4 in binary.
- Sai from "The Perfect Match" being nudged by the AI agent Tilly to tell him that he prefers the beautiful girl in the "2+2=4" T-shirt.

Some Lenses

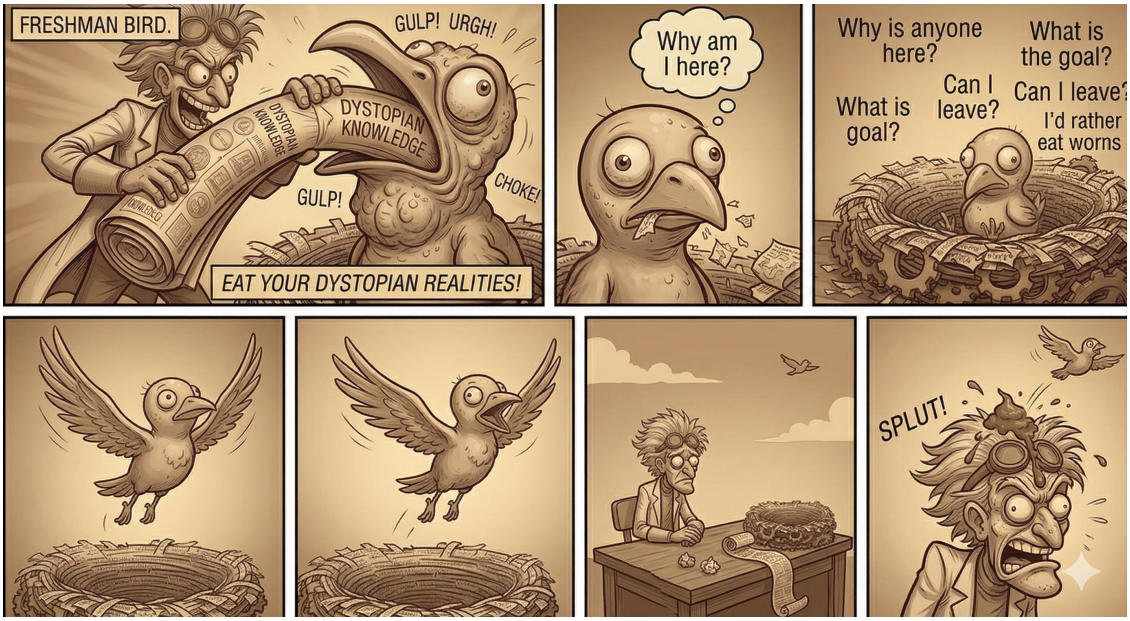


- **Michel Foucault:**
  - The panopticon (prison) of thought.
  - The surveillance state.
  - Postmodernism.
  - Civilization constraining madness.
- **Jerome Bruner:** Narrative Analysis
- **Herbert Marcuse:** Control through false needs.
- **Gilles Deluze:**
  - Foucault's "enclosures" (prisons, schools, hospitals) are breaking down.
  - We are no longer "individuals" in a room; we are "dividuals"—data points, bank codes, and digital footprints that are tracked in an open, continuous loop of control.
  - It's not about being locked in a cage; it's about being part of a network where the "control" is fluid and constant.

Course Parody:

- I can get pretty excited by my own stuff.
- Watch out that I don't force a point of view on you.

Course Goals:



- You should ask questions.
- Thought-opening not thought-stopping.
- So you can fly away in your own individual way.
- Even if it means rejecting my framing.
- gary larson:
  - two prisoners handing by rests, just cloth on privates, dirty, beards
  - little window with bars
  - one looking out: "hey, I can see me house from here"